

22 Jun 2026 12:47:05 ET | 12 pages

China Aluminum

Addressing Investor Concerns; Reiterate Buy on Hongqiao and Chalco

CITI'S TAKE

According to mysteel, China operating aluminum capacity is 45.3mntpa on 22nd Jun 2026 and total aluminum output is expected to reach 45.4mnt in 2026E considering possible slight overproduction. The NBS's monthly aluminum output data is more spiky than SMM and Mysteel data hence less used by industry participants. Citi commodity team remains bullish on aluminum and expects average aluminum price at ~US\$4,000/t in 3Q26E. We see aluminum price and margins will stay higher for longer and the strong free cash flows will continue to support dividends and buybacks for equities. We see the weakness as an opportunity to buy shares. Maintain Buy on both Hongqiao and Chalco with attractive valuation.

China capacity – According to mysteel, China operating aluminum capacity is 45.3mntpa on 22nd Jun 2026 and total aluminum output is expected to reach 45.4mnt in 2026E considering possible slight overproduction. Investors' concerns of 48mntpa capacity was based on annualized China aluminum output in Apr 2026 reported by NBS. However, mysteel expects aluminum output data reported by NBS was more fluctuated and could be misleading as the annualized China aluminum output in May 2026 reported by NBS decreased to 45.8mntpa. In addition, the monthly operating capacity calculated from NBS's output data since Mar 2025 has been fluctuated and even decreased MoM at some months, which is different from industry's view that aluminum utilization ratio has kept increasing with hiking profitability. We expect there is no change in the capacity cap policy in China (see our [note](#)).

Overseas aluminum inventory and capacity – Mysteel expects the aluminum inventory in the Middle East that could be transported out after the reopening of Strait of Hormuz is less than 400kt. For Indonesia capacity addition, mysteel expects power supply is a key focus in addition to the construction of aluminum capacity. It takes time for the construction of power units and the ramp-up of aluminum capacity. Mysteel expects total overseas aluminum capacity addition at 1.85mntpa in 2026E, contributing 1.2mnt aluminum output, while total overseas aluminum output will decrease 1.6mnt YoY after considering the impact from capacity suspension in the Middle East and slight resumption in Europe. In 2027E, mysteel expects overseas aluminum output to increase ~3mnt YoY after the production resumption in the Middle East and some overseas capacity addition.

Remain bullish on aluminum price – Citi commodity team remains bullish on aluminum and expects average aluminum price at ~US\$4,000/t in 3Q26E as Strait of Hormuz reopening stabilizes demand faster than it restores supply. Citi commodity team expects the aluminum market as being in a genuine deficit phase of ~2Mt primary deficit in 2026E and ~270kt primary deficit in 2027E. See more from our note [here](#).

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Reiterate Buy on Hongqiao and Chalco – We see aluminum price and margins to stay higher for longer and the strong free cash flows to continue to support dividends and buybacks for equities. We see the weakness as an enhanced opportunity to buy shares. Maintain Buy on both Hongqiao and Chalco with attractive valuation.

Figure 1. Aluminum names 26E P/E sensitivity to aluminum price

Change in Aluminum price	Change in 2026E net profit		Aluminum price (Rmb/t)	2026E Net Profit (Rmb mn)		Aluminum price (Rmb/t)	2026E P/E		
	Chalco	Hongqiao		Chalco	Hongqiao		Chalco-A	Chalco-H	Hongqiao
-20%	-71%	-55%	18,581	5,950	14,222	18,581	28.4	21.5	13.7
-15%	-53%	-41%	19,742	9,513	18,609	19,742	17.8	13.5	10.4
-10%	-35%	-28%	20,903	13,076	22,995	20,903	12.9	9.8	8.5
-5%	-18%	-14%	22,064	16,639	27,381	22,064	10.2	7.7	7.1
0%	0%	0%	23,226	20,203	31,767	23,226	8.4	6.3	6.1
5%	18%	14%	24,387	23,766	36,153	24,387	7.1	5.4	5.4
10%	35%	28%	25,548	27,329	40,539	25,548	6.2	4.7	4.8
15%	53%	41%	26,710	30,892	44,925	26,710	5.5	4.1	4.3
20%	71%	55%	27,871	34,456	49,311	27,871	4.9	3.7	3.9

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Note: Based on alumina price at Rmb2,843/t in 2026E and as of market close on 22nd Jun

Source: Citi Research

Figure 2. Aluminum names 26E EV/EBITDA sensitivity to aluminum price

Aluminum price (Rmb/t)	2026E EBITDA (Rmb mn)		Aluminum price (Rmb/t)	2026E EV/EBITDA		
	Chalco	Hongqiao		Chalco-A	Chalco-H	Hongqiao
18,581	26,257	32,695	18,581	9.0	7.5	6.6
19,742	34,034	39,514	19,742	7.0	5.8	5.4
20,903	41,812	46,333	20,903	5.7	4.7	4.6
22,064	49,589	53,152	22,064	4.8	3.9	4.0
23,226	57,366	59,971	23,226	4.1	3.4	3.6
24,387	65,143	66,790	24,387	3.6	3.0	3.2
25,548	72,921	73,610	25,548	3.2	2.7	2.9
26,710	80,698	80,429	26,710	2.9	2.4	2.7
27,871	88,475	87,248	27,871	2.7	2.2	2.5

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Note: Based on alumina price at Rmb2,843/t in 2026E and as of market close on 22nd Jun

Source: Citi Research

Aluminum Corporation of China

(601600.SS; Rmb9.86; 1; 22 Jun 26; 15:00)

Valuation

Our target price for the Chalco A-share of Rmb17.24/sh is based on 3.28x 2026E PB, set at 2SD above the historical average of 1.86x as we expect stronger-than-historical-average 2026-27E ROEs, benefitting from higher aluminum price.

Risks

Downside risks that could impede the stock from reaching our target price are: 1) lower-than-expected aluminum and alumina prices; 2) higher-than-expected costs; 3) higher-than-expected impairment loss; and 4) the Chinese government may loosen its supply cut policies if aluminum prices overshoot.

Aluminum Corporation of China

(2600.HK; HK\$8.58; 1; 22 Jun 26; 16:10)

Valuation

Our target price of HK\$17.08/sh for the Chalco H-share is based on 2.83x 2026E PB, set at 2.25x SD above the historical average of 1.27x to reflect stronger-than-historical-average 2026-27E ROEs, benefitting from higher aluminum price.

Risks

Downside risks that could impede the stock from reaching our target price are: 1) Lower-than-expected aluminum and alumina prices; 2) Higher-than-expected costs; 3) Higher-than-expected impairment loss; and 4) The Chinese government may loosen its supply cut policies if aluminum price overshoots.

China Hongqiao

(1378.HK; HK\$22.76; 1; 22 Jun 26; 16:10)

Valuation

Our target price for Hongqiao of HK\$48.0/sh is based on 13.0x 2026E PE, set at China peers average. Our target price implies 2.7x 2026E PB and 12.9x 2026E PE.

Risks

Major risks that could impede Hongqiao from reaching our target price include: 1) cost and capex overruns; 2) higher-than-expected capacity addition in the industry; and 3) a significant slowdown in the Chinese economy.

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Appendix A-1

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Aluminum Corporation of China (2600.HK)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Jack Shang, CFA



Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1 04-Oct-23 09:06:45	1	*5.96	4.21
2 12-Dec-23 10:00:35	1	*5.51	3.59
3 11-Apr-24 11:41:48	1	*7.88	5.20
4 15-Oct-24 18:49:20	1	*9.09	6.10

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
5 29-Oct-24 10:06:17	1	*8.89	5.53
6 02-Jun-25 10:34:49	1	*7.60	4.59
7 29-Jul-25 11:38:09	1	*7.47	6.47
8 02-Nov-25 22:06:33	1	*12.41	9.88

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
9 07-Jan-26 10:23:57	1	*15.94	13.46
10 22-May-26 07:12:45	1	*17.08	10.87

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Aluminum Corporation of China (601600.SS)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Jack Shang, CFA



Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1 04-Oct-23 09:06:45	2	*7.12	6.28
2 12-Dec-23 10:00:35	*1	*7.18	5.23
3 11-Apr-24 11:41:48	1	*9.70	7.33
4 15-Oct-24 18:49:20	1	*10.96	8.51

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
5 31-Oct-24 12:12:41	1	*10.72	7.63
6 02-Jun-25 21:44:39	1	*9.62	6.54
7 29-Jul-25 11:30:20	1	*9.68	7.71
8 02-Nov-25 22:06:33	1	*14.77	9.99

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
9 07-Jan-26 10:32:16	1	*16.74	14.05
10 22-May-26 07:14:31	1	*17.24	11.15

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

China Hongqiao (1378.HK)

Ratings and Target Price History Fundamental Research

Analyst: Jack Shang, CFA



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	20-Aug-23 13:05:13	1	*8.70	6.92
2	12-Dec-23 10:00:35	1	*9.30	5.80
3	01-Apr-24 03:07:57	1	*11.50	8.80
4	02-May-24 04:55:09	1	*13.80	11.22

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
5	15-Oct-24 18:49:20	1	*14.80	12.84
6	17-Jan-25 09:11:17	1	*15.00	12.68
7	20-Mar-25 11:42:49	1	*21.00	15.46
8	29-Jul-25 11:28:03	1	*25.20	21.35

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
9	04-Nov-25 04:34:03	1	*36.00	29.68
10	08-Apr-26 10:07:49	1	*48.00	37.36

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Aluminum Corporation of China (2600.HK)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Jack Shang, CFA



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	22-May-24 04:40:28	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	5.63
2	21-Jun-24 00:24:50	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	5.46
3	16-Jul-24 14:50:56	Add CW	Downside	30 Days	5.19
4	16-Aug-24 00:12:08	Remove CW	Downside	30 Days	4.43

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
5	16-Aug-24 07:31:42	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	4.43
6	16-Sep-24 00:14:55	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	4.67
7	15-Oct-24 14:49:20	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	6.10
8	29-Oct-24 06:06:17	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	5.53

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
9	02-Jun-25 06:34:49	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	4.59
10	03-Jul-25 00:22:45	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	5.48
11	14-Apr-26 04:28:27	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	12.68
12	15-May-26 00:28:25	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	10.54

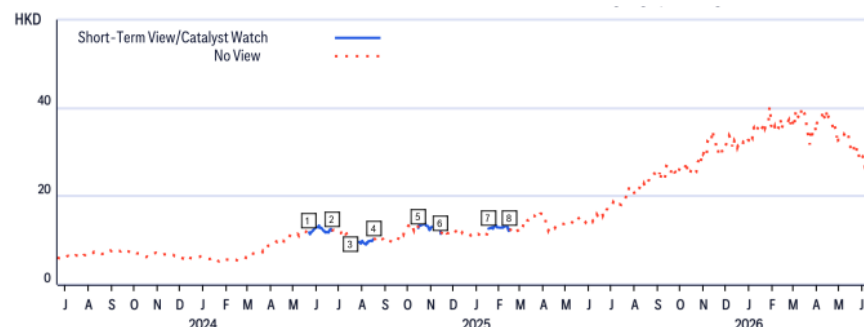
CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

China Hongqiao (1378.HK)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Jack Shang, CFA



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	22-May-24 04:40:28	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	11.84
2	21-Jun-24 00:25:11	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	12.22
3	16-Jul-24 14:50:56	Add CW	Downside	30 Days	10.64

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
4	16-Aug-24 00:12:32	Remove CW	Downside	30 Days	10.32
5	15-Oct-24 14:49:20	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	12.84
6	14-Nov-24 22:28:30	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	11.52

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
7	17-Jan-25 04:11:17	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	12.68
8	16-Feb-25 22:14:31	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	12.58

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Aluminum Corporation of China
(601600.SS)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Jack Shang, CFA



Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
16-Jul-24 14:50:56	Add CW	Downside	30 Days	7.91
15-Aug-24 23:12:08	Remove CW	Downside	30 Days	6.55
15-Oct-24 14:49:20	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	8.51
31-Oct-24 08:03:43	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	7.63
14-Apr-26 04:27:40	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	12.46
14-May-26 23:28:26	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	11.61

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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